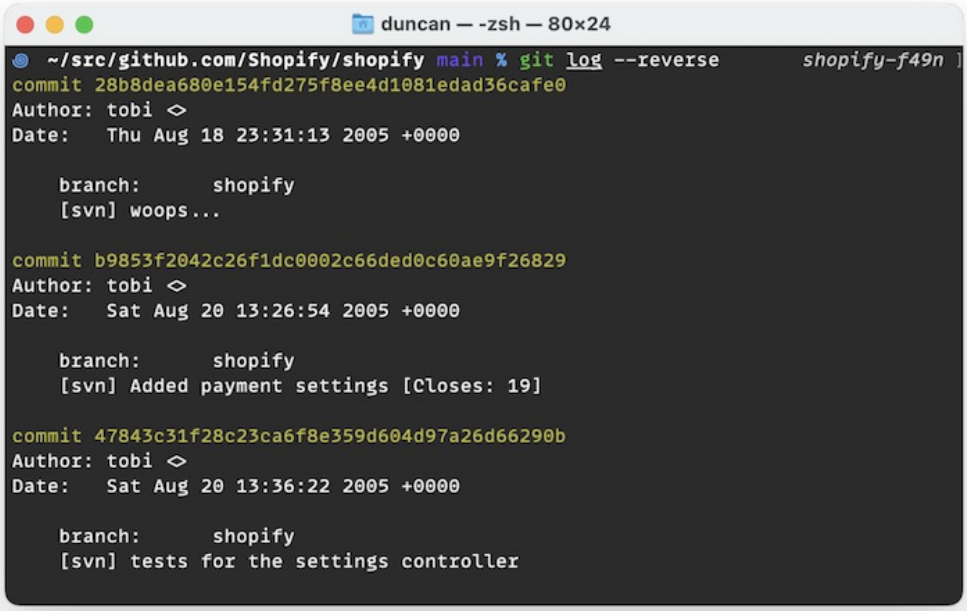


Now, I'm not going to argue that you should learn and use Rails because it's what Shopify, GitHub, and many other fantastic companies use. That's not a very strong argument. However, a strong argument is that companies like Shopify and GitHub use Rails because it's excellent for what *we* want to do. And, it might be just the right tool for what *you* wish to do as well. Even if you go on to use other things, learning Rails will open your eyes to a deeper appreciation of *how* to build web applications.

I still remember the huge smile it gave so many years ago when I first installed the original version of Rails and started to play around with it. At the time, I'd been building for the web for almost a decade and thought that I knew pretty much everything I needed to know. It turns out that I had a lot to learn. And that experience reminds me to this day that there's still so much to learn.

I wish you the best as you start your journey to learning Rails, and I hope it gives you the same big smile that it's given so many other people as they've learned it. Last but not least, you're in the best of hands. Dave Thomas was the person who helped bring Ruby to the English-speaking world and taught so many of us how to get the most out of the language. And, over two decades, I've learned so much